CHANDA BWALYA

Barry University | Miami, Florida | Chandabwa00@gmail.com
B.S. Biology Candidate | Chemistry Minor | Aspiring Physician Associate

ACADEMIC PROFILE

Undergraduate Biology student and CRAFT Scholar with experience in cancer prevention research, quantitative survey analysis, scientific communication, community health education, and undergraduate teaching. Research interests include preventive medicine, health disparities, and translating evidence into accessible community-based interventions.

EDUCATION

Barry University | Miami, Florida

Bachelor of Science in Biology; Minor in Chemistry | Expected Spring 2027 | Cumulative GPA: 3.47

Selected coursework: Genetics, Biochemistry I, Medical Microbiology, Human Anatomy with Laboratory, Parasitology, Organic Chemistry I with Laboratory, General Biology and Chemistry with Laboratories, Physics I with Laboratory, Medical Terminology.

The Diocesan School for Girls | South Africa

High School Diploma | 2021

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Summer Research Intern | University of Florida, Gainesville, FL | Summer 2026

- Contributed to cancer prevention research through the Sun Safe Workspace Program, focused on sun-safety education for outdoor professionals, and Eat Right, Screen Right, focused on colorectal cancer screening awareness.
- Cleaned, merged, and organized research datasets using Excel and SPSS; supported descriptive and pre/post intervention analyses of survey responses, knowledge, and behavioral intentions.
- Collaborated with faculty mentors and interdisciplinary colleagues on research interpretation, scientific communication, and conference poster preparation.
- Supported the development and launch of a digital outreach campaign for Eat Right, Screen Right, communicating preventive screening information through social media.

CRAFT Scholar Researcher | Barry University / Cerasee Farm | 2024–Present

- Conducted community-engaged research exploring urban agriculture, food security, sustainable production, and links between environmental conditions and community health.
- Participated in planting, harvesting, and distributing produce to local families through community partnerships and USDA-supported initiatives.
- Presented findings at the Barry University STEM Symposium, strengthening research communication and public engagement.

SCHOLARLY PRESENTATIONS AND PROJECTS

Forthcoming Poster Presentation | SACNAS Conference | October 29–31, 2026

Venue: Long Beach Convention Center, Long Beach, California.

Title: Exploring Skin Cancer Prevention Behaviors Through a Tailored Approach for Outdoor Professionals: Year 1 Implementation Results from Florida's Sun Safe Workspace Program.

- Poster presents an exploratory evaluation of a tailored sun-safety educational intervention delivered to outdoor professionals across four Florida counties.
- Examines pre- and post-intervention survey measures related to participant characteristics, sun exposure history, knowledge, protective practices, and behavioral intentions.

Urban Farming and Food Security | Barry University STEM Symposium | 2025

Presented research on community-based sustainable agriculture, food access, and environmental sustainability.

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Microbiology Laboratory Teaching Assistant | Barry University | Fall 2026–Present

- Assist with undergraduate microbiology laboratory instruction and provide academic support to students during laboratory sessions.
- Support student understanding of microbiological concepts, laboratory procedures, and course activities under instructor guidance.

Teaching Assistant | Nkhwazi Primary School, Lusaka, Zambia | 2021

- Assisted classroom teaching and supported students in reading, writing, and foundational literacy.
- Provided individualized learning assistance and helped facilitate classroom activities.

UNIVERSITY EMPLOYMENT AND PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Clerical Assistant | Biology Department, Barry University | July - August 2026

- Provide administrative and front-desk support, greet students and visitors, answer calls, take messages, and assist with departmental inquiries.
- Perform data entry, maintain biology bulletin boards and alumni displays, prepare flyers, and assist with administrative projects.
- Support the student resource room, assist with computer needs, and monitor departmental printer use.

Student Wellness Ambassador | Health Promotion & Wellness, Barry University | August 2023–Present

- Coordinate student wellness programs and campus events addressing preventive health, safety, and well-being.
- Support outreach, event logistics, partnerships, and program evaluation for activities such as the Well-Being Fair, Take Back the Night, Beyond the Sheets Workshop, and Men's Health Barbershop.

Barista | Joe & The Juice, Washington, DC | September 2022–May 2023

Prepared food and beverages, supported high-volume service, and strengthened communication and teamwork in a customer-facing environment.

Barista | Starbucks, Rhode Island | January–August 2022

Supported daily store operations, beverage preparation, and customer service in a fast-paced setting.

LEADERSHIP AND SERVICE

Co-Director | Medi Futures Club, Barry University | Current

- Help lead a pre-health organization providing virtual shadowing, healthcare career exploration, and professional development opportunities.
- Coordinate student engagement, organizational planning, and communication with members and student leaders.

Treasurer | Pre-Physician Assistant Club, Barry University

Supported budgeting and professional development programming for students exploring physician assistant careers.

Community Volunteer | Orphanage, Makhanda, South Africa | 2017–2021

Tutored children in reading, writing, and mathematics; supported fundraising for food, clothing, and educational materials.

HONORS AND AWARDS

CRAFT Scholar | Dean's Award (2023–Present) | Dean's List (Spring 2025–Present) | Gold Certificate (Top 5%), Royal Geographical Society Antarctic Module (2020).

RESEARCH AND PROFESSIONAL SKILLS

Research: Survey data management, data cleaning, descriptive statistics, pre/post analysis, literature review, scientific writing, poster design and presentation.
Software: Microsoft Excel, SPSS.
Additional: Undergraduate teaching support, health communication, outreach, event coordination, interdisciplinary teamwork.